

KYLE GAARDER

Member Experience Designer | Community Programming | Ops

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SUMMARY

Member experience designer who builds community programming from scratch. Designed and ran the complete resident experience at a coliving property - 48 weekly events, 4 mastermind programs, and 6 work-trade initiatives. I specialize in creating intentional, relationship-driven, operationally excellent member experiences in shared spaces.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
- 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed complete member experience - onboarding, engagement, retention, and conflict resolution
 - Ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs from scratch
 - Built community-driven retention sustaining 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
 - Executed A/B pricing experiments driving 48% revenue lift while maintaining member satisfaction
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY
- across all member touchpoints
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining
- community trust and continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots
- community outreach
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand member needs and experience preferences
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Led member experience design across strategy, ops, and community in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎 **Complete MX from Scratch**
- Designed end-to-end member experience - onboarding, engagement, events, and resolution
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- 💎 **48+ Community Programs**
- Built 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs driving member engagement
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- 💎 **94% Retention via Experience**
- Experience-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
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- 💎 **Investor Pilot Secured**
- Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
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- 💎 **Demand Pipeline Built**
- Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Member Experience Design
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- Community Programming
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- Operational Excellence
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- Event Design & Facilitation
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- Retention Strategies Onboarding
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- Conflict Resolution Comms
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- Partnerships Market Creation
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EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
- Virginia Tech
- 📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
- 📍 Virginia, USA
- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA
- 3.5 / 4.0**